



Beginning of the end: In what could likely be Sunil Chhetri's final season of professional football, Bengaluru FC has brought in Jose Pereyra Diaz, Alberto Noguera, and Rahul Bheke, all from Mumbai City. PTI

» INDIAN SUPER LEAGUE

# Shock transfer, familiar contenders and Marquez's dual role headline new ISL season

The upcoming Indian Super League season promises **renewed optimism** as teams gear up for a thrilling battle for the top.

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**A**fter another disappointing result for the national team in June, which led to the sacking of Igor Stimac, and the retirement of long-serving national team captain Sunil Chhetri, a new season of the Indian Super League (ISL) will be underway, bringing renewed optimism.

The All India Football Federation (AIFF), however, will not be

imposing relegation at the end of this season, deviating from the 2019 Asian Football Confederation's (AFC) proposed roadmap. The league has also done away with the mandatory rule requiring an overseas AFC member player to be included in the playing XI. Mohammedan SC is the newly promoted side, having won the I-League for the first time.